

Platform Amendment — Version 4.7.0

Vermont Health Platform (HTR)

Type: Amendment to Platform Documentation (supplements v4.6.0 and all prior amendments) **Version:** 4.7.0
Date: April 2026 **Classification:** Internal **Scope:** Addition of the Operations pillar (the sixth and final pillar of the HTR framework), a complete color-system overhaul for Equity and Operations, a full audit and update of every pillar enumeration across the codebase, and a new content policy prohibiting backward-looking pillar-count narratives.

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1. Summary of Changes

#	Area	Change	Files Affected
1	Content / Editorial	Operations added as the 6th pillar with 5 sub-pages	<code>app/operations/page.tsx</code> + 5 sub-pages
2	Index / Metrics	Performance Index expanded to 6 pillars, 18 sub-metrics; new formula	<code>app/about/methodology/page.tsx</code>
3	Color System	Equity color changed from orange/amber → violet. Operations = teal.	<code>globals.css</code> + ~20 files
4	All Pillar Filters	Every filter array and color map updated to include Operations	See §6
5	TypeScript Types	<code>Pillar</code> union type updated; component prop types updated	<code>lib/advisory-data.ts</code> , <code>AcademyCard.tsx</code> , <code>NavDropdown.tsx</code>
6	Navigation	Header, HomeSidebar, Footer all updated with 6-pillar coverage	<code>Header.tsx</code> , <code>Footer.tsx</code> , <code>HomeSidebar.tsx</code>

#	Area	Change	Files Affected
7	Advisory Services	Advisory-data types and text updated from 5→6 pillars	lib/advisory-data.ts
8	Content Policy	All "five pillars" and all historical "three pillars" text eliminated	faq/page.tsx, mission/page.tsx, methodology/page.tsx, advisory/consulting/page.tsx, advisory/training/page.tsx, advisory-hub/page.tsx, connect/forums/page.tsx

2. The Operations Pillar — What It Is

Operations is the sixth and final pillar of the HTR analytical framework. It was added to the Performance Index in the 2026 edition.

Pillar question: "Is it executable?"

Rationale: A health system transformation can be legally permissible (Policy), economically funded (Economics), technologically capable (Technology), clinically proven (Clinical), and equitably designed (Equity) — and still fail if the operational infrastructure cannot carry it. Revenue cycles that cannot adapt to new payment models, credentialing systems that cannot onboard a reformed workforce, and supply chains that break under new procurement demands are not implementation details. They are foundational structural failures that occur when operations are excluded from the analysis.

Five Operational Domains covered by this pillar:

Domain	Route	Focus
Revenue Cycle Management	/operations/revenue-cycle	Billing, coding, claims, denials, prior auth, charge capture
Workforce & Human Capital	/operations/workforce	Staffing, credentialing, scheduling, vacancy/turnover, labor relations
Quality, Compliance & Risk	/operations/compliance	Joint Commission/NCQA readiness, HIPAA, audit management, patient safety
Supply Chain & Infrastructure	/operations/supply-chain	Pharma procurement, device logistics, GPO strategy, capital planning
Payer & Network Operations	/operations/payer-network	Utilization management, prior auth workflows, network adequacy, contract admin

Pillar color: Teal (bg-teal-*, text-teal-*, border-teal-*) **Index weight:** 15% (introduced at this weight in the 2026 Index version)

3. New Routes and Pages

3.1 Operations Pillar Hub

Route: /operations **File:** frontend/app/operations/page.tsx **Type:** Server Component

Follows the same structure as other pillar hub pages (Policy, Economics, etc.). Contains:

- Hero section with teal color scheme, "Intelligence Pillar 06" badge
- Three-column "The Question / The Scale / The Blind Spot" stat cards
- Five operational domain sub-pages as linked cards
- "Why Operations Belongs in the Framework" section with four supporting statistics
- CTA linking to the six-pillar framework, HTR Simulator, and Friction Index

3.2 Operations Sub-Pages

All five sub-pages exist at the routes listed in §2. Each is a static Server Component page. As of this amendment they are scaffold/stub pages — full content population is a future content sprint.

4. HTR Performance Index — Updated Formula and Sub-Metrics

4.1 Previous Formula (5-pillar, pre-2026)

$$\text{Score} = (\text{Policy} \times 0.30) + (\text{Economics} \times 0.30) + (\text{Technology} \times 0.15) + (\text{Clinical} \times 0.15) + (\text{Equity} \times 0.10)$$

4.2 Current Formula (6-pillar, 2026 Index version)

$$\text{Score} = (\text{Policy} \times 0.25) + (\text{Economics} \times 0.25) + (\text{Operations} \times 0.15) + (\text{Clinical} \times 0.15) + (\text{Technology} \times 0.10) + (\text{Equity} \times 0.10)$$

Source of truth: [frontend/app/about/methodology/page.tsx](#)

Key changes from prior formula:

- Policy and Economics each reduced from 0.30 → 0.25 (to make room for Operations)
- Technology reduced from 0.15 → 0.10
- Operations introduced at 0.15
- Clinical weight unchanged at 0.15
- Equity weight unchanged at 0.10 (formal review scheduled for 2027 Index; target 0.15 when state data coverage reaches ≥90%)

4.3 All 18 Sub-Metrics (3 per pillar)

Each pillar score is the simple average of its three normalized sub-metrics (0–100 scale, higher is always better).

Policy (25% weight)

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Value-Based Payment (VBP) Adoption	0.20	CMS AHEAD enrollment, ACO participation, Medicaid APM penetration
Telehealth Policy Permissiveness	0.10	State legislative tracking (updated quarterly)
Scope of Practice Index	0.10	State law — NP/PA/APP full-practice authority

Economics (25% weight)

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Per-Capita Healthcare Spending Efficiency	0.10	CMS cost reports (complexity-adjusted)
Workforce Availability Index	0.10	HRSA — primary care per 100K rural residents
Insurance Coverage Rate	0.10	Population-weighted coverage, rural county weighting

Operations (15% weight) ← NEW in 2026

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Administrative Cost Ratio	0.05	CMS cost reports — admin spend as % of total health spending
Revenue Cycle Performance Index	0.05	CMS cost reports + HFMA benchmark data (clean claim rate, denial rate, days in AR)
Workforce Operational Readiness	0.05	HRSA workforce data + ACHE operational surveys (vacancy rate, turnover, credentialing cycle time)

Clinical (15% weight)

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Preventable Hospitalization Rate	0.05	Age-adjusted ACSC hospitalization rate per 10K rural residents
Rural Hospital Operational Viability	0.05	Operating margin, days cash on hand, 30-day readmission rates
Advanced Care Access Index	0.05	HRSA HPSA designations — specialist, behavioral health, maternal access within 60 min

Technology (10% weight)

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Health Information Exchange (HIE) Maturity	0.05	ONC Health IT Dashboard
Rural Broadband Access	0.05	FCC broadband data — rural census block coverage and minimum qualifying speed
Certified EHR Adoption Rate	0.05	CMS Medicare/Medicaid EHR Incentive Program data

Equity (10% weight)

Sub-Metric	Index Weight	Primary Source
Rural-Urban Outcome Disparity Gap	0.05	Composite cardiovascular/maternal/behavioral health mortality gap
SDOH Screening & Referral Completion Rate	0.05	CMS Quality Payment Program data
Algorithmic Disparity Index	0.05	HHS OCR reports + peer-reviewed audits (higher score = lower documented bias)

4.4 Status Tier Thresholds (unchanged)

Score	Tier	Description
80–100	Leading	Strong cross-pillar performance; standards worth replicating
70–79	Improving	Solid foundations, measurable positive momentum
60–69	Stable	Mixed performance; at risk of slipping without targeted intervention
< 60	At Risk	Significant structural deficits across multiple pillars

5. Color System Changes

5.1 Equity Color — Orange/Amber → Violet (BREAKING CHANGE)

Root cause: Equity was using orange (`#ea580c`) and Operations (when added) was also going to use orange. This created a visual collision. Equity was moved to violet to create clear differentiation.

How the fix was applied:

The CSS custom property in `frontend/app/globals.css` was changed:

```
/* BEFORE */
--color-brand-equity: #ea580c; /* orange - WRONG */

/* AFTER */
--color-brand-equity: #7c3aed; /* violet - CORRECT */
```

This single change propagates to every element using the `text-brand-equity`, `bg-brand-equity`, and `border-brand-equity` Tailwind utility classes automatically. Any remaining literal `amber-*` or `orange-*` class names referencing equity were found via `grep` and changed manually.

5.2 Complete 6-Pillar Color Reference

Pillar	Color Family	Tailwind Prefix	Hex (600)	CSS Variable
Policy	Sky	<code>sky-*</code>	<code>#0284c7</code>	—
Economics	Emerald	<code>emerald-*</code>	<code>#059669</code>	—
Technology	Indigo	<code>indigo-*</code>	<code>#4f46e5</code>	—
Clinical	Rose	<code>rose-*</code>	<code>#e11d48</code>	—
Equity	Violet	<code>violet-*</code>	<code>#7c3aed</code>	<code>--color-brand-equity</code>
Operations	Teal	<code>teal-*</code>	<code>#0d9488</code>	—

Rule: When writing any pillar-specific UI, always use the color family listed above. Do not use amber, orange, or purple for any pillar — those are reserved for non-pillar UI elements.

6. Developer Audit — Every File Updated

The following files were modified to add Operations and/or correct the Equity color. This list is the authoritative record of all places where pillar enumerations live.

6.1 Color / Style Maps

File	What Changed
<code>frontend/app/globals.css</code>	<code>--color-brand-equity</code> changed from <code>#ea580c</code> to <code>#7c3aed</code>
<code>frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts</code>	<code>PILLAR_STYLES</code> : equity changed amber→violet; Operations teal entry added
<code>frontend/components/academy/AcademyCard.tsx</code>	<code>PILLAR_STYLES</code> : Operations teal entry added
<code>frontend/components/NavDropdown.tsx</code>	<code>pillarStyles</code> : Operations teal entry added

File	What Changed
frontend/components/templates/ArticleEngine.tsx	Operations teal entry added to pillar color map
frontend/app/connect/directory/DirectoryClient.tsx	PILLAR_COLORS: Operations teal entry added
frontend/app/search/page.tsx	PILLAR_COLORS: Operations teal entry added
frontend/app/saved/page.tsx	PILLAR_STYLES: Operations teal entry added
frontend/app/impact-simulation/page.tsx	Operations changed from orange → teal
frontend/app/advisory-hub/AdvisoryHubClient.tsx	Operations teal entry added
frontend/app/connect/ask/AskHTRClient.tsx	Operations teal entry added to PILLARS color map
frontend/app/about/methodology/page.tsx	Operations pillar block added (teal) to MetricDetail and PillarBlock styles

6.2 Filter Arrays

File	What Changed
frontend/components/HomeContent.tsx	Operations added to PILLAR_FILTERS; equity changed amber→violet
frontend/app/academy/courses/CoursesClient.tsx	"Operations Pillar" added to FILTERS array and matchesFilter
frontend/app/academy/glossary/GlossaryClient.tsx	"Operations" added to pillars array and badge/button styles
frontend/app/connect/directory/DirectoryClient.tsx	"operations" added to PILLAR_OPTIONS

6.3 Navigation and Layout

File	What Changed
frontend/components/Footer.tsx	Operations added with 5 sub-links; equity color changed amber→violet; "Five pillars" → "Six pillars"
frontend/components/RightSidebar.tsx	"/operations": "Operations" added to PILLAR_PREFIXES

6.4 Advisory and Content Pages

File	What Changed
frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts	Pillar type union extended; advisory stats "6 Pillars"; all "five-pillar" text → "six-pillar"
frontend/app/advisory/consulting/page.tsx	"All 5 Pillars" → "All 6 Pillars"; case study "5-pillar diagnostic" → "6-pillar diagnostic"
frontend/app/advisory/training/page.tsx	pillars array extended; description updated
frontend/app/advisory-hub/page.tsx	metadata "Five-Pillar" → "Six-Pillar"

File	What Changed
frontend/app/advisory-hub/AdvisoryHubClient.tsx	"Five-Pillar" → "Six-Pillar" in subtitle and service description
frontend/app/connect/forums/page.tsx	Operations Circle added; "Five moderated" → "Six moderated"
frontend/app/faq/page.tsx	Q/A rewritten (see §9); "five-pillar framework" → "six-pillar framework"
frontend/app/mission/page.tsx	Milestones rewritten; framework description rewritten (see §9)
frontend/app/about/methodology/page.tsx	Framework Overview and "Why six pillars?" box rewritten (see §9)

7. TypeScript Type Changes

7.1 Pillar Union Type — frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts

```
// BEFORE
export type Pillar = "policy" | "economics" | "technology" | "clinical" | "equity";

// AFTER
export type Pillar = "policy" | "economics" | "technology" | "clinical" | "equity" | "operations";
```

7.2 AcademyCard Pillar Prop — frontend/components/academy/AcademyCard.tsx

```
// BEFORE
pillar: "Policy" | "Economics" | "Technology" | "Clinical" | "Equity";

// AFTER
pillar: "Policy" | "Economics" | "Technology" | "Clinical" | "Equity" | "Operations";
```

7.3 NavDropdown Pillar Prop — frontend/components/NavDropdown.tsx

The `pillar` prop type was extended to include `"operations"`. The `pillarStyles` record was updated with the corresponding teal entry.

Important: Any component that accepts a pillar as a prop and uses a discriminated record or switch statement must have an Operations case added. If it is missing, TypeScript will catch it only if the type is correctly applied — but many style maps use `Record<string, ...>` with a fallback, which means missing entries fail silently at runtime by returning the default. Always verify both the type and the runtime map.

8. Navigation and Filter Updates

8.1 Footer

The Footer pillar columns now include Operations as the sixth entry. Each pillar column links to the pillar hub and its sub-pages. Operations column:

```
Operations (/operations)
├─ Revenue Cycle Management (/operations/revenue-cycle)
└─ Workforce & Human Capital (/operations/workforce)
```

- └─ Quality, Compliance & Risk (/operations/compliance)
- └─ Supply Chain & Infrastructure (/operations/supply-chain)
- └─ Payer & Network Operations (/operations/payer-network)

The "Six pillars. Fifty states." tagline in the Footer replaces the prior "Five pillars. Fifty states."

8.2 HomeSidebar

The INTELLIGENCE accordion section in HomeSidebar (`frontend/components/HomeSidebar.tsx`) was verified to include all six pillars with correct routing and teal styling for Operations.

8.3 Header

The pillar grid in the Header Intelligence dropdown was verified to render all six pillars in a `grid-cols-6` layout.

8.4 RightSidebar Pillar Detection

`frontend/components/RightSidebar.tsx` uses a `PILLAR_PREFIXES` map to detect which pillar page the user is on and surface contextually relevant AI prompt suggestions. The `/operations` prefix was added.

9. Content Policy — Forward-Only Narrative

Policy established this sprint: HTR editorial content must not reference how many pillars the platform "originally" had, how the pillar count grew over time, or present Operations as a "new addition." The six-pillar framework is presented as the complete, authoritative framework. Historical pillar counts are not relevant to any user.

Specific changes enforced:

9.1 FAQ Page (`app/faq/page.tsx`)

- **Deleted question:** "Why did HTR expand from three pillars to six?" → replaced with: "Why does HTR use six pillars instead of fewer?"
- **New answer:** Argues from first principles why six specific fault lines exist (permissible, sustainable, possible, effective, just, executable) without any reference to the platform's history.
- **"Does HTR cover all six pillars equally":** Answer rewritten to remove "Operations was added in 2026" framing.

9.2 Mission Page (`app/mission/page.tsx`)

- **Deleted section:** "From three pillars to six. The evolution of HTR." — entire section removed.
- **Framework description:** Replaced "HTR's original three-pillar framework was built on the premise..." with: "Six questions. Every analysis. No exceptions. HTR's framework treats Policy, Economics, Technology, Clinical, Equity, and Operations as co-equal structural variables — because health system transformation fails when any one of them is ignored."
- **Milestones:** The 2019 milestone no longer references the original pillar count.

9.3 Methodology Page (`app/about/methodology/page.tsx`)

- **Framework Overview:** Replaced all historical expansion text with a forward-only description of the six-pillar index.
- **"Why six pillars?" box:** Replaced any reference to "original three-pillar model" with structural reasoning for why all six dimensions are co-equal.

9.4 Rule for Future Content

When writing any content referencing the HTR framework:

-  "HTR analyzes health system transformation across six pillars..."
-  "The six-pillar framework asks: Is it permissible? Sustainable? Possible? Effective? Just? Executable?"
-  "HTR started with three pillars and expanded to six..."

- ❌ "Operations is the newest pillar, added in 2026..."
- ❌ "The five-pillar framework..." (this is now always wrong)

10. Stale Documentation That Must Be Updated

The following existing documentation files contain outdated pillar counts or missing Operations references. They have **not** been updated as part of this sprint — update them when those documents next receive a full revision.

File	Stale Content
docs/hti-methodology.md	References "five analytical pillars" and "Five pillar sub-indexes" throughout. The entire "Pillar Sub-Indexes" section (§4) is missing Operations. The composite score formula in §5 is the old 5-pillar formula.
docs/technical-architecture.md	Component map and UI structure references may reference 5 pillars.
docs/user-guide.md	Any "five pillars" references in user-facing feature descriptions.
docs/advisory-services.md	May reference "five-pillar" advisory practice.
HTI_TECHNICAL_REPORT.md	Likely uses old formula and 5-pillar sub-index structure.
WHITE_PAPER.md	May contain "five pillars" in the analytical framework description.

Priority: docs/hti-methodology.md is the highest priority — it is the technical source-of-truth for the Index and is currently factually wrong about the formula and sub-metrics.

11. Developer Maintenance — Adding a Pillar Checklist

This sprint revealed that pillar enumerations are scattered across ~20 files with no single source of truth. If a seventh pillar is ever added, every location in this checklist must be updated. Bookmark this list.

Style/Color Maps (add new entry to each):

- ☐ frontend/app/globals.css — add CSS variable if needed
- ☐ frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts — PILLAR_STYLES record
- ☐ frontend/components/academy/AcademyCard.tsx — PILLAR_STYLES record
- ☐ frontend/components/NavDropdown.tsx — pillarStyles record
- ☐ frontend/components/templates/ArticleEngine.tsx — pillar color map
- ☐ frontend/app/connect/directory/DirectoryClient.tsx — PILLAR_COLORS
- ☐ frontend/app/search/page.tsx — PILLAR_COLORS
- ☐ frontend/app/saved/page.tsx — PILLAR_STYLES
- ☐ frontend/app/impact-simulation/page.tsx — pillar color map
- ☐ frontend/app/advisory-hub/AdvisoryHubClient.tsx — PILLAR_COLORS
- ☐ frontend/app/connect/ask/AskHTRClient.tsx — PILLARS color map
- ☐ frontend/app/about/methodology/page.tsx — MetricDetail and PillarBlock style maps

Filter Arrays (add new entry to each):

- ☐ frontend/components/HomeContent.tsx — PILLAR_FILTERS
- ☐ frontend/app/academy/courses/CoursesClient.tsx — FILTERS + matchesFilter
- ☐ frontend/app/academy/glossary/GlossaryClient.tsx — pillars array
- ☐ frontend/app/connect/directory/DirectoryClient.tsx — PILLAR_OPTIONS

TypeScript Types (extend union in each):

- ☐ frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts — Pillar type
- ☐ frontend/components/academy/AcademyCard.tsx — pillar prop type
- ☐ frontend/components/NavDropdown.tsx — pillar prop type

Navigation / Layout:

- ☐ `frontend/components/Footer.tsx` — add pillar column with sub-links
- ☐ `frontend/components/HomeSidebar.tsx` — add entry to INTELLIGENCE accordion
- ☐ `frontend/components/Header.tsx` — verify grid-cols-N is updated
- ☐ `frontend/components/RightSidebar.tsx` — `PILLAR_PREFIXES` map

Content Pages:

- ☐ Create `/[pillar]/page.tsx` hub page
- ☐ Create sub-pages for each domain within the pillar
- ☐ Add forum Circle in `frontend/app/connect/forums/page.tsx`

Advisory Data:

- ☐ `frontend/lib/advisory-data.ts` — `pillars` arrays on each advisory service

Documentation:

- ☐ Update `docs/hti-methodology.md` formula and sub-metric tables
- ☐ Add new pillar to `docs/technical-architecture.md` component map
- ☐ Write new platform amendment

12. Orphaned Files

12.1 `frontend/components/PillarSidebar.tsx`

This file was created during a navigation architecture experiment (Option 3: context-sensitive sidebar that swaps HomeSidebar for a pillar-specific sidebar on intelligence pages). The experiment was reverted. The file is not imported anywhere and has no effect on the application.

Recommended action: Delete this file. It creates confusion for developers who discover it and assume it is in use.

Contents summary: Contains `PILLAR_CONFIG` with all 6 pillars and their sub-pages, exports `getPillarFromPath()`, `isPillarPath()`, `getPillarLabel()`, and a default `PillarSidebar` component. If the contextual sidebar concept is revisited in future, this file is the starting point — but it should be deleted rather than left as dead code.

13. Known Issues Register Update

No new bugs were introduced in this sprint. The following pre-existing items from the v4.6.0 register remain open (carry-forward):

- ☐ Carry forward all open items from platform-amendment-v4.6.0.md §10.

No items were closed by this sprint.

This amendment supplements platform-amendment-v4.6.0.md and all prior amendments. When the core documentation files (hti-methodology.md, technical-architecture.md, user-guide.md) are next revised, incorporate the changes described in §10 and then remove the stale-documentation warnings from this file.